

Beatrocity



Introduction:

The purpose of this documentation is to convey the design and gameplay of the game Beatrocity.

Section 1: Overview

Concept: Beatrocity is a rhythmic shooter. The player dual wields pistols designed to work in tandem with music. Alone they must face off against swarms of robots that also function with music.

Setting: Weapons Prototype Lab with security lockdown in Australia

Genre: Time-Based Rhythmic Shooter

Target Audience: People interested in First Person Shooters and have access to VR

Art Style: Hard dystopian sci-fi in cell shading. Similar to what you'd get if you combined borderlands with shadowrun



Section 2: Gameplay and Mechanics

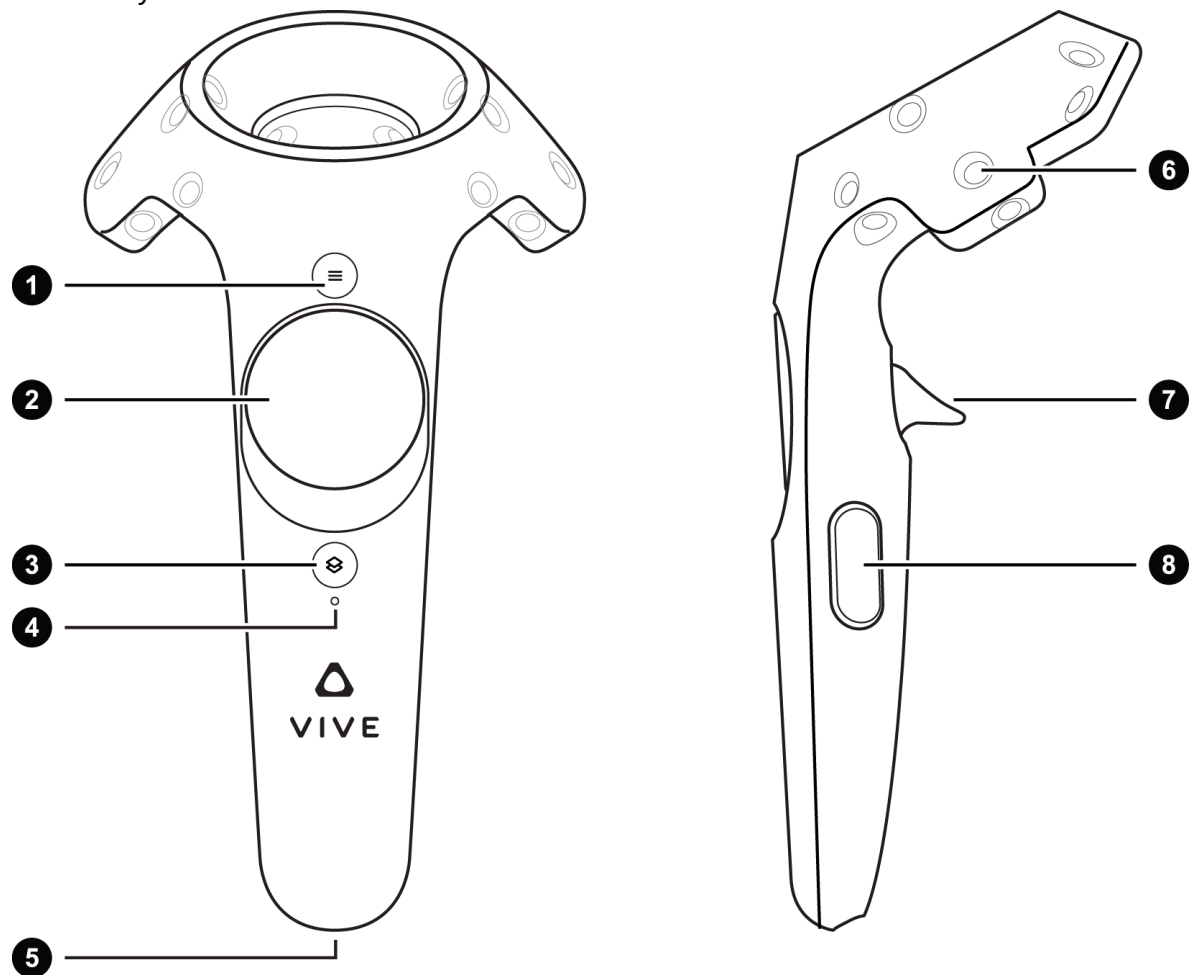
Gameplay & Progression:

- Objective: Time-based survival. The duration of the song is the time the player needs to survive.
- Scoring: The player will earn score for shooting on beat and defeating enemies but they do get penalised for shooting off beat or missing beats. The best scores will be saved so that players can attempt to beat them.
- Replaying: the game will have replayability as they try to beat the highscores. The game will also support the ability for players to choose their own songs. If a player leaves mid-song, they lose the progress and accumulated score.

Mechanics:

- **Physics:** The game will use standard physics. The enemies will move on a rail and won't be affected by gravity until they die. However, the player is free to move on their own and as such will be affected by gravity all the time. This would mean if the player were to dash off a small edge, they will fall down onto the floor.
- **Movement:** the player's movement will be done using a dash system. This is activated by pressing any direction on the D-Pad to move a small distance in the direction (Relative to where the player is looking). We chose to use a dash as it's less jarring for the player allowing them to play the game longer.
- **Object Interaction:** The game will not contain object interaction as the guns are locked in the players hands and cannot be dropped.
- **Weapons:** The guns are aimed and fired with the VR controllers, each of the players guns can be fired but work on individual "Tracks". 1 gun works on beat notes and the other on melody notes. The guns will have no recoil. The weapons will also not have to be reloaded as the guns are locked in the players hands. They fire plasma balls that gain strength and distance when shot on beat. The penalty for shooting off beat is that the gun has reduced range, reduced damage and decrease scores. Shooting off beat continuously will cause a stacking score penalty.
- **Enemies:** The enemies in the game will move and shoot with the music. There will also be different types of enemies, ranging from standard melee enemies to ranged enemies. The enemies will come in different sizes and shapes and provide different amounts of score with varying amounts of health.
- **Power Ups:** The game will contain few power ups, which are collected by the player dash to them. These power ups are score multipliers (x2, x4) as well as unlimited dasing and health pickups. These pick ups would drop from enemies randomly on death. These pickups still need to be hit on beat otherwise they won't be activated.
- **Difficulty:** The difficulty of the level is dependent on the music choice. If the song has breaks or long periods of minimal music, they would make it easier for the player. Where as songs with rapid fire notes and no breaks would be considered harder.

Control layout:



- 1 - Opens the menu
- 2 - The 4 way D pad is used for dashing in the given direction
- 7 - Fires the given gun either the beat gun or the rhythm gun

Section 3

Interface

Menu:

- The menu will be floating in front of the player
 - The menu will have a Resume button, Options button which would open an options menu and an exit button
- While the menu is active the game is paused
 - This is to stop the player from getting killed while in the menu
- The menu is operated by shooting the buttons/options instead of pressing them.
 - This is to make the more immersive to make the menu easier to interact with in VR
- From the Options menu, the players can adjust audio levels, dominant hand and speed.
 - Dominant Hand would be the gun that handles the beat, so left gun for left hand, right gun for right hand and speed is so players can artificially increase the difficulty of the song if they wish

HUD:

- The score is projected on/from the gun, each gun keeps track of it's own score which get added up at the end of the song. The guns also will have a light that pulses through the gun and to the barrel to show when the next note is about to hit. Pulse speed is relative to the time till next note.

Section 4 Story, Setting and Characters

Story and Narrative:

- Backstory: the government has started experimenting with music to create a new series of combat droids and weaponry. Of course this has outraged people as they believe music is entertainment and an embodiment of peace. You are an agent for a group that wants to thwart these projects called . Your mission is to secure the prototype weapons and dismantle and droids you come across. It's time to commit a Beatrocity.
- Plot Elements: Voice cues, Environment cues

Characters:

- Player

- Personality: The player's personality is the strong silent type. One that does not say much but gets the job done. This developed during his childhood in which he joined a gang while young and learnt to keep his mouth shut and just do as he is told. As he grew up though he started seeing the error of his ways and joined the police when he turned 18. As he grew older he started seeing injustice everywhere and turned into a freelance mercenary, with a preference for jobs that dealt with corruption or criminals.
- Look: Rugged and mostly covered, wears a coat over armor. Prefers wearing a helmet
- Reference Images:



- Enemies:
 - Look:

World Feel:

- Looks and Feel:
 - Sci-fi Pristine Lab, night, stormy
 - Lab: Computers, Terminals, Assembly Line, Manufacture Robots, Cameras, Lights, Windows

Level Design:

- Synopsis:
 - You're a mercenary hired by Musiberation to break into a Lab of an Arms company to steal their newest weapons prototype. Upon securing the weapons, you've triggered a security lockdown, now you gotta fight for your survival.
- Objectives:
 - Survive until the song as ended. The player needs to survive till the song ends to escape and secure the weapons.
- Physical Description:
 - The Lab it self is comprised of a big single room with multiple different corridors leading into it which the enemies will come from.
- Map:

- The player will be able to walk around the big room and may look into the corridors but will not be able to enter them as only the enemies can walkthrough them.
- Critical Path:
 - There is no critical path as the only objective that the player needs to fulfil is surviving till the end of the song.
- Encounters:
 - The enemies will spawn in a continuous fashion but only in beat with the music as is their movement. This would mean that either A. the player will be able to kill them as they spawn and not get overrun or B. the player misses too many beats and gets overrun.

Audio:

- Music:
 - The songs that “Ship” with the game should be either Techno/Synth as the game is Sci-fi. If players don’t like that music, they’ll be able to import their own music.
- Sounds:
 - The game sounds will reflect what’s happening in game, to create a feedback loop. This includes gun firing sounds, player movement, enemy movement and enemy death sounds.